

Annual Report

Action Year-2009

Developmental Association for Human Advancement-Dehat

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Developmental Association for Human Advancement-Dehat Bahraich

The Introduction

1.1 Genesis-

Developmental Association for Human Advancement, which is popular as “Dehat”, is an autonomous voluntary developmental association working in the Bahraich district of Uttar Pradesh state. Dehat was established in the year of 1989-90 by some enthusiastic youths residing in the most backward rural areas.

It started its activities through a school opened for ‘Tharu’ tribals and forest village children.

After ten years of establishment, it got registered under society registration act 21, 1860 on dated 20 August 2000.

1.2 Philosophy

Dehat believes that sustainable development can only take place when the rural masses are mobilized to take active part in their on development.

Its also feel children are young human being. As human beings children evidentially have a certain moral status. There are things that should not be done to them for simple reason that they are human being. At the same time children are different from adult human beings and it seems reasonable to think that there things children may not do that adult are permitted to do. What makes children a special case for philosophical consideration is the combination of there humanity and the youth or more exactly there are our next generation of the society, if we ensure the child rights which are needed for the sound development of a civilized human being of children, we can fulfill the dream of a sustained and developed society.

1.3 Vision and Mission

About 40% of total population in our country is of children. Dehat believe that without achieving the rights of children, we can't make our country happy, prosperous and developed. The childhood decides the nature of a future citizen.

Vision

To build a child centered society in which all children enjoy their rights and lead fulfilling lives.

Mission

To empower the deprived and under privileged sections of the society to ensure basic rights of the children.

Approach

'Dehat' believes in the motto of 'to help people to help themselves'. Hence, right from the beginning, 'Dehat' has adopted 'Right based approach' in implementing all the activities at grass root level. We never lead but promote people's leadership to solve their problems.

The Geographical Coverage

'Dehat' is intervening as under:

Districts	Blocks	No. of Gram Panchayats
Bahraich	1. Chittaura	32
	2. Payagpur	27
	3. Mihinpurwa	13
	4. Fakhar Pur	02
	5. Tejwapur	05
	6. Risia	05
	7. Huzurpur	05

Key Strategies

Dehat promotes community organizations of the poorest families at community, hamlet, village, Gram Panchayat and block level in the adopted areas and then educate and empower them through their regular meetings, trainings and exposures to undertake all the developmental activities at their own with ensuring social justice and equity.

Dehat also organize training, exposure and sensitization efforts for the elected members of Panchayats and Gram Sabha to strengthen the rural self-governance system.

Consequently, we intend to offer these efforts to the people only up to the time when they are empowered enough to leverage all these facilities at their own. There after we see our role only as an educator and facilitator.

‘Dehat’ Action Year : 2008 – 2009

‘Dehat’ design its projects by keeping the children in focus. During the action year-2008-09, the projects were as follows:

S. No.	Project Title	Funding Agency	Covered District	Covered Blocks	Covered Gram Panchayats
1	Child Right Project-Azaadi	Child Rights & You, New Delhi	Bahraich	Mihinpurwa	8 (Forest Villages)
2	Sure Start Project	PATH International and BAIF-Pune	Bahraich	Chittaura & Payagpur	59
3.	Lok Nidhi	NABARD-Lucknow	Bahraich	Chittaura & Payagpur	139
4.	Village Development Plan	NABARD-Lucknow	Bahraich	Fakhar Pur	01
5	AROH	GEAG & OXFAM India	Bahraich	Chittaura	10
6	Right To Information Campaign	Community Contribution	Bahraich	Chittaura Tejwapur Risla Huzurpur Fakharpur	05
7	Five Year District Perspective Planning for NREGA	Agriculture Finance Corporation, Mumbai	Basti	Basti Sadar Harriya Kaptan Ganj Dubauliya Bahadurpur	332

Child Right Project

(A Project for Ensuring the Rights of Children in the forest villages)

The Child Rights Project was started in the year 2005 in the 8 forest villages (the villages inhabited on forest lands) in *Mihinpurwa block of Bahraich district* in *Uttar Pradesh* state with the help of *CRY- Child Right and You, New Delhi*.

The children as well as the residents of these villages were not considered as Indian citizens and as result they were not considered eligible for any type of Govt. schemes, no residence and caste and income certificate was issued by any Govt. official to these forest village residents. Due to lack of residence, caste and income certificates, these villagers were not eligible for opening their bank accounts in any recognized bank and taking bank loans for self employment initiatives, applying in Govt. jobs, applying for passport etc. The children of these villages were living with a dark future. The names of the forest villages are; *Bhawanipur, Bichhia, Bichhia Bazar, Kailashnagar and Nishad Nagar (Dhakia), Nai Basti (Tedhia) , Katernia Ghat, Gokulpur (Dafadar Gaurhi) and Rampur Retia*. All these villages have a *population of 6413 lives in 1034 households*.

To ensure the rights of this right less population, following activities were organized during the year 2008-2009 -:

Right To Survival

Immunization of Pregnant Women and children

Due to the remote forest covered area situated at the distance of 43 Km. from the Block Primary Health Centre, no ANM was visiting to provide pre, ante and post natal care.

To ensure the right to survival, the demands were sent through the Community Health Rights Committees to the Govt. health officials. After several efforts, the immunization was given to 234 women and 302 children in the area.

Demand Generation for the ICDS Centers

This is shocking that there is not a single ICDS Centre in the forest villages even after the strict directions of Honorable Supreme Court for ensuring Right To Food to all.

For ensuring nutrition and good health to all the children, the demands were sent to District Administration. For this, a post card campaign for sending 878 post-cards and 17 registered letters demanding ICDS centers were sent to Honorable President, Prime Minister, Chief Minister, Governor and Higher officials.

Accept above, 12 applications under Right To Information Act were sent to higher authorities to know the official reasons for no coverage of forest villages under ICDS Scheme.

The result is awaited.

Right To Protection

Forest Rights Campaign

In the month of December-2007, an act named: Scheduled Tribes and Traditional Forest Dwellers (Recognition of Forest Rights) Act-2007, now well known as “Forest Rights Act” came into existence. The forest dwelling community was struggling for the execution of this act since a long time.

During the year, the focus was on ‘forest rights’. For this, the community was facilitated to participate in ‘Van Adhikar Samities’ proposed under the act as well as in upper level committees for the fair implementation of the act. To build the capacity of ‘Van Adhikar Samities’, a series of 4 trainings were organized at our field office at A-17, Girijapuri Colony, Bahraich for 40 members and 15 volunteers.

During the year, the claims of 638 forest dweller families were processed and sent to the Sub-Divisional Committee for the settlement.

Removal of Child Labor and mainstreaming of working children

During the year, 23 child laborers were removed from western part of Uttar Pradesh, Punjab and other states by motivating parents. Similarly, 138 working children were mainstreamed by admitting them in schools.

Community Based Organizations

To ensure the child rights in the right-less forest villages, the whole community is organized in 8 Vangram Azadi Sangharsh Samitis having active membership of 2652 and its apex body Vangram Adhikar Manch.

Similarly, the children are also organized in 10 Kishori Sangathans (the groups of adolescent girls) having a membership of 189 girls, and 8 Baal Adikar Manch (the groups of all children) having a membership of 642 children.

During the year, 24 meetings with Kishori Sangathans and 196 meetings with 8 Bal Adikar Manchs were organized and the knowledge on health and hygiene, education, relevant laws, role of children on ensuring education to all children, child labor, working children and higher education etc was given to strengthen the capacity to participate in the development process.

Capacity Building Programmes

To promote the community leadership and to strengthen the negotiation power of the CBOs as well as the individuals, the programmes were organized through-out the year. There 8 programmes were organized during the year on Right to Information, Forest Right Act, Search and Rescue training during disaster for youths, Career Counseling workshop with Youths, Environment Protection and Right to Education etc. with 186 community leaders and youths.

Right To Development

Operation of Non-Formal Education Centers

There is only one Govt. School (without building) in the area of 8 villages against the need of 4 schools for 1178 school aged children. Maximum parents were motivated to send their children in nearby Govt. schools. But for the 179 children of Nishad Nagar village, 78 children of Kailash Nagar and 278 children of Bhawani Pur and Bichhia village, 3 Non-formal Education Centers were opened as "Child Right Centers". One another Child Right Center was opened in Nai Basti with 100% community contribution.

Demanding Schools

To ensure the education to all children, two Non Formal Education Centers were opened in Nishadnagar and Kailash Nagar. For the non-school and drop-out children of all villages, the "Education Right Committees" were constituted in each village and the demands for schools or alternative education centers were sent to the Govt. officials through these committees. As result, a center under Education Guarantee Scheme was also opened in Nishad Nagar village.

'Education To All' Campaign

To ensure the quality education to all children especially girls, a campaign in the months of May-June and July was organized by door-to-door contacts, rallies, community mobilization campaigns, wall writings and community meetings.

As a result, a total of 889 children were admitted in Govt. Primary Schools- Bichhia Bazar, Sirsian Purwa, Vijay Nagar and Kurkuri Kuan.

Ensuring Higher Education to Girl Child

Due to the dense forest area, the maximum guardians were made up their mind for not sending their daughters to the upper-primary or higher level schools. The reason was distance of Middle/High Schools.

To overcome the problem, 'Dehat' made it's effort to organize all the school going girls into 'Kishori Mandals' (Adolescent Girls Groups). During the year, there 10 such groups were organized with 288 girls and motivated them and their parents for higher education. Now, all the girls are going to schools for higher education.

Camps with collaboration of Govt. agencies

Free human and animal health camp

To prevent the children and domestic animals from the epidemics during and post disaster (flood), a free human and animal health camp was organized at Bichia Bazar primary school of Mihinpurwa Block on 23 March,2008 with the help of District Disaster Management Programme. There 642 patients were treated, 346 children were immunized and 542 animals were given preventive doses.

Camp for the insurance of mentally Retarded children/persons

There are 42 children and adults were identified as the sufferers of mental disabilities and often at the time of illness, they suffer a lot due to poverty. They often ignored by the family also. Keeping the right to survival in mind, a collaborative effort with the State Nodal Agency of National Trust was made to ensure the affected people. During the year, 18 children and 21 adult persons affected from mental disability were provided free health insurance worth Rs. 1 Lac. to each under "Niramaya Yojna".

Distribution of Equipments to physically challenged

With the collaboration of Handicapped Welfare Department of Uttar Pradesh govt. a camp was organized on 14 June, 2008 in SSP Inter College, Girijapuri to provide aids to the persons with disabilities. During the camp, a total of 21 persons were given clutches, tricycles and other aids.

Right To Participation

To ensure the child rights to participation, we have organized the following programmes:

Child Festival

The child festival was organized on 14th November-2008. In the festival, the children had demonstrated their talents by performing theatre shows, folk songs, games, competitions and debates.

This year, 588 children were participated in the festival.

Mr. Manoj K. Shukla-Range Officer, Mr. Banshi Dhar Baudh-Member Zila Panchayat, Mr. Girijapati Tripathi-NPRC Coordinator and other 474 parents were also participated in the programme.

After the festival, all the children were given prizes.

Bal Adhikar Manch (Children's Rights Forum)

Their 8 Bal Adhikar Manch (BAMs) are organized in 8 villages. All the BAMs has 4 committees namely; Education Committee, Participation Committee, Health & Hygiene Committee and Discipline Committee. All the committees perform the duties well and present it's report in the fortnightly meetings of BAM. Currently, 642 children are the members.

During the year, 196 meetings were organized on the child rights issues.

Celebration of Independence Day and Republic Day

On 15th August-2008, the Independence Day was celebrated at the project office in Girijapuri Colony. A total of 498 (Girls-288 and Boys-210) children were participated and organized various programmes.

Similarly, the Republic Day was celebrated on 26th January, 2009.

Participation of Children in Community Based Organizations (CBOs)

To develop leadership and capacity to express their views at any forum, 'Dehat' has ensured the participation of children in the CBOs organized at each level.

In the forest villages, each 'Vangram Azaadi Sangharsh Samiti (VASS)' is constituted by 20 members. It has been decided that the 25% members will be the children and the children participate all the meetings of VASS. During the year, the children were participated in 192 meetings.

Other Activities

Flood Relief

During the months of July to September-2009, the 34 villages of Mihinpurwa block suffer from severe floods. During the emergency, we have supported 2032 families with food packets, clothes and basic items of daily use.

We have also driven a campaign against the after flood epidemics due to contaminated water and poor sanitation. During the preventive campaign, we have disinfected 438 shallow-bore handpumps and 31 wells in Mihinpurwa block. We have organized 21 camps to aware people about Govt. guidelines for providing disaster relief to the victims.

Achievements

- In human health camp 468 patient and in animal health camp 600 animals were treated free of cost.
- With help of NIRAMAYA YOJNA operated by National trust Govt. of India, 38 **Mentally** Retarded children were insured with amount of Rs. 100000 Lac. without any premium.
- Under residential 09 month Bridge Course, 60 children out of 83 children of forest village were bring to mainstream of basic education.
- 158 children of two forest village who were deprived of education were enrolled in NFE center for getting informal education.
- Two EGS center were opened by education department under Education guarantee Scheme.
- 23 children of forest village were freed from child labor this year.

- All the 991 families covered under the 'Child Right Project' were registered in the 'Family Register Part-2' (A document necessary for getting the benefits of Govt. Schemes).
- All 991 families were issued residence certificate by the Sub Divisional

Magistrate.

- A quota of 2000 liters of Kerosene oil was increased by the govt. for 08

forest villages under PDS system.

SURE START PROJECT

(A project for Maternal and Neo-natal Health Care)

Sure Start Project is supported by Bill and Millinda Gets foundation, PATH International USA and BAIF Pune is aimed to reduce maternal and neo-natal deaths in the Bahraich district. 'Dehat' is the partner in two blocks of Baharaich district namely Chittura and Payagpur.

By 2011, there will be improved knowledge and service delivery mechanism for promoting maternal and neo-natal health and preventing maternal and neo-natal deaths from Chittaura and Payagpur blocks.

Currently we are covering *32 Gram Panchayats in Chittaura and 27 Gram Panchayats in Payagpur block of Bahraich district.* Activities which are performed during this year to meet the aim of project are as under:-

The Project Purpose

Catalyze sustainable improvement of maternal and new born status through effective community action in designated blocks of Bahraich district.

The Key Strategies

1. Strengthening of existing institutions like Village Health and Sanitation Committees [VHSCs] at Gram Panchayat level, Mother Group-MG at ICDS center level, Rogi Kalyan Samiti-RKS at block level.
2. Capacity building and networking of ASHAs, ANMs and ICDS Workers at Gram Panchayat level.
3. The main focus will be on the capacity building of the ASHAs for effective performance of her duties.

The Objectives

The basic objectives are as follows:

1. To significantly increase individual, household and community action that directly and indirectly improves maternal and new born health.

2. To enhance systems and institutional capabilities for sustained improvement in maternal and new born care and health status.

The interventions

The major four interventions are given below:

- Community Mobilization, demand generation and facilitating an enabling environment.
- House hold skill building in essential maternal and new born care and seeking.
- Facilitating access to skilled attendance at birth and essential commodities such as safe delivery kits and essential antibiotics to manage severe infections.
- Strengthening of linkages between communities and the public and private care system.

The Activities

a. Trainings and Orientations

For the sustainability of efforts, 'Dehat' believes in the investment in human resource development. We have organized various programmes for the capacity building of ASHAs (Accredited Social Health Activists), Gram Pradhans, Mother Groups and Govt. Officials.

The details are under:

- a. **ASHA orientations** were organized 3 times in both the intervention blocks in which 67 ASHAs from Payagpur and 83 ASHAs from Chittaura were participated in all the three programmes.
- b. **Orientations of Block Level officials** were conducted on quarterly basis in both the intervention blocks. During the year 3 programmes were organized in each block. The programmes were aimed to review the progress and ensure the co-operation of each stakeholder department in the project.
- c. The role of local self governance institutions is too important in the success of any programme at grass root level. In the Sure Start project, we realize that the Village Health and Sanitation Committees (VHSCs) are an important part of the project. Hence, we have organized the 'Trainings of Pradhans on MNH issue and VHSC Functions'.

b. Campaigns

To mobilize the community and to create an environment to protect the neo-natal and mothers, 'Dehat' organizes campaigns on periodical basis. During the year, the campaigns organized in the area are as under:

S. No.	Name of Campaign	Duration	Covered Areas	Participation		
				Male	Female	Total
1	Breast Feeding Week	07.08.2008 to 13.08.2008	Chittaura and Payagpur Blocks	5321	8234	13555
2	Nutrition Week	05.09.2008 to 12.09.2008	Chittaura and Payagpur Blocks	4778	6897	11675
3	Campaign on Safe-motherhood	11.04.2008	Chittaura and Payagpur Blocks	1277	2346	3623
	Total			11376	17477	28853

d. Community Mobilization

'Dehat' use innovative methods for community mobilization. Some key methods are as under:

Participatory Wall paintings and wall writing in project village

To aware community towards the stake holders on the maternal and neo-natal health care issues, reasons for maternal and neo-natal deaths and behavior change in traditional practices, 118 wall paintings were made by using participatory methods and involving people.

Street Theatre

We have organized 164 theatre shows in the 59 intervention villages and reached to more than 80,000 population directly with the messages to save the lives of maternal and neo-natals.

Video Van Promotion

With the collaboration of IMPACT India, PATH International and BAIF, we have organized 72 video shows on maternal and new born care in both the intervention blocks. More than 35000 people were benefited.

Innovative Tools for Community Education

We use innovative community education tools named 'Thermal Care Tool', Cord Cutting Tool', and 'Birth Preparedness Tool'. In these tools we use toys, plastic passels and games based on snake and ladder game and Ludo. Community play these tools/games in the quality facilitation of our Field Coordinators.

Residential Bridge Course for Non-school and Drop-Out Boys

**(A Project for Educating Non-school and Drop-out Children supported by the
Educational Directorate, Department of Education-UP)**

Due to the severe poverty, there were many drop-out and non-school working children engaged in cattle rearing as shepherd and other domestic works.

To ensure the educational right of these children, a Residential Bridge Course Center was started in Girijapuri Colony of Mihinpurwa block for 60 boys.

The programme was started in December-2008 for 9 months but, closed in March-2009 due to a circular of Govt. Of India to close all such type of programmes under Surva Shiksha Abhiyan from entire country.

During the programme, 38 children out of 60 were found addicts of tobacco, pan masala, hemp, smoking and liquor.

By using innovative methods and strict prohibition on punishment, the centre has completed its 3 months against the proposed curriculum of 9 months.

Finally, 54 out of 60 children were mainstreamed and admitted in the nearby Govt. Primary Schools situated in Matehi, Bijay Nagar, Jangal Gulariha and Bichhia.

RIGHT TO INFORMATION-RTI

‘Dehat’ promotes Right To Information Act as an effective tool to empower the deprived sections for their struggle towards their rights. ‘Dehat’ is providing RTI support in the following manners:

a. Helpline on RTI

We have established two helplines no. 05252-291184 and 09984557591 to help the victims of corruption. During the year, we have received 1176 calls.

b. Camps on RTI

We organize camps to help the victims of corruption directly. In the camps, we conduct community meetings on the RTI Act and correlate the solutions of existing problems with RTI. After the meetings, the applications are drafted on spot by ‘Dehat’ team.

During the year, 9 such camps were organized with 3778 villagers and 2876 applications were drafted and sent to the relevant Govt. departments. By this

process, the justice was ensured to 1234 victims on individual problems and 89 community problems.

c. Model Villages through RTI

‘Dehat’ has selected 5 Gram Panchayats in 5 blocks namely Bhauri(Fakhar Pur Block), Bhawaniapur Ramgarhi (Risla Block), Parsaura (Chittaura), Gauriya (Huzurpur) and Meer Ganj-Shekh Daheer (Tejwapur) to develop models. Among the activities, we have organized 60 camps (12 camps in each Gram Panchayat) during the year and facilitated 60 persons to use RTI act on the issues affecting their lives. A total of 300 applications were sent to the concerned departments.

As a result, 32 landless families got possession on patta-lands, 78 poor families were prevented from the fake payment of electricity bills without any connections, 66 families got compensations against house loss during floods and a lot of deprived families have got benefited from Govt. schemes.

Lok Nidhi

(A NABARD Supported Project aimed to Socio-Economic and Political Empowerment of poorest Sections)

Promotion of Women Self Help Groups (SHG)

‘Dehat’ promotes Self Help Groups of women from poorest families for their socio-economic and political empowerment.

‘Dehat’ has formed and linked 166 women SHGs. At present, 2458 poorest families are associated with the SHGs.

The details on SHGs are as under:

No. of SHGs	166
No. of SHGs Saving Linked	138
No. of SHGs Credit Linked	116
Total Savings	Rs. 18.78 Lac.
Total Internal Loaning	Rs. 22.66 Lac.
Total Interest Earned	Rs. 1.28 Lac.
SHGs Attempts towards the entitlement realization	78

Entrepreneurship and Micro Enterprise Development

With the help of SHGs and the banks, ‘Dehat’ has promoted 578 micro-enterprises.

For this, we have facilitated the poorest families to utilize their savings as well as bank loan in a proper manner. In the regular SHG meetings, we have conducted various sessions on ‘Entrepreneurship Development’. The results are encouraging.

RIGHT TO WORK

Micro-level Planning and Survey for the Participatory District Perspective Plan for 5 years to Implement NREGA in UP (A Project supported by Agriculture Finance Corporation- Mumbai for the 5 Year Perspective Planning in Basti District of Uttar Pradesh)

'Dehat' feel that the planning is a most important aspect of any scheme or programme. National Rural Employment Guarantee Scheme (NREGA) has given an opportunity to the jobless laborers to get 100 days job in their own village.

To ensure the livelihood for coming 5 years, 'Dehat' has planned to intervene in the 332 Gram Panchayats of 5 blocks of Basti district to prepare the 5 Year perspective plans. All the prepared plans were submitted to the Govt. of Uttar Pradesh through Agriculture Finance Corporation.

The plan will provide the 100 days jobs to 78,990 jobless laborers of covered area.

"Kaam Mango" ("Demand the Job") Campaign

National Rural Employment Guarantee Scheme (NREGA) is a scheme which is completely based on demand. Any laborer can get job card, job or unemployment bonus but only on demand.

It is observed that the 'demand' part is lacking in the community. Keeping this in view, we have organized a 'Demand the Job' Campaign in 3 blocks (Chittaura, Payagpur and Mihinpurwa) in the month of March-2009 and facilitated 3879 job card holders to demand the jobs in written form. As result, 18322 man days were generated worth Rs. 18,32,200.

Village Development Plan-VDP

(A NABARD Supported initiative to develop a Gram Panchayat in Totality through Participatory Planning and Convergence)

Jagtapur is situated at the distance of 34 Km. from the district headquarter and 15 Km. from block headquarter on the bank of Saryu River. The road goes to Jagtapur end here because of no bridge on the river.

Jagtapur is a Gram Panchayat where the poverty and backwardness can be visualized in an extreme position. It consists 22 hamlets and 13 out of these are flood affected. About 500 beegha (100 Acres) land is affected with water logging. There are no regular sources of income due to lack of house hold industries or any institutional source. More than 80% population is living below poverty line. More than 100 youths are migrated from the village in search of livelihood sources.

To improve the situation, 'Dehat' has prepared a participatory integrated development plan. The Gram Panchayat has approved it and after approval it was shared with the National Bank of Agriculture and Rural Development-NABARD, Lucknow Regional Office. NABARD has also approved it. To implement the plan, a committee was constituted with 16 Govt. departments and local bank (Lucknow Kshetriya Grameen Bank) in the Chairmanship of Project Director-District Rural Development Authority. The committee called 'Jagtapur Gram Vikas Samiti'.

'Dehat' is only a facilitator to achieve the goal to develop this village as a model.

During the year, the following goals defined in the 'Village Development Plan' were achieved:

- | | | | |
|----|---|---|--------------|
| a. | Construction of soil link roads under NREGA | : | 4350 Meters. |
| b. | Construction of sanitary sock-pits | : | 25 |
| c. | Cross drainage | : | 01 |
| d. | Sanitary Toilets | : | 73 |
| e. | Constriction of Ponds (25X40 Meters) | : | 01 |
| f. | Drainage | : | 125 Meters. |
| g. | Construction of Houses for weaker sections | : | 26 |
| h. | Formation of Self Help Groups | : | 08 |

The proposals for other programmes have been sent to the concerned departments. The committee conducts the meeting in each quarter to review the progress.

CHAPTER - 5

The Team

S. N.	Name of Staff	Designation	Qualification	Experience	Full Time/ Part Time
1	Dr.Jitendra Chaturvedi	Cheif Executive	M.A., B.H.M.S.	16 Year	Full time
2	Mr.KhajanchiLal Yadav	Block Programme Coordinator	M.A.	4 Year	Full time
3	Mr. Ajay Kumar	Accountant	B.Com, M.A	4 Year	Full time
4	Suresh Kumar Shukla	Field Coordinator	High School	5 Year	Full time
5	Mr. Satguru Marya	Field Coordinator	BA	8 Year	Full time
6	Mr.Nand KishorVerma	Field Coordinator	BA	3 Year	Full time
7	Mr. Raj Kumar	Field Coordinator	BA	5 Year	Full time
8	Dr. Jang Hindustani	Associate Coordinator	MA, ND [Naturopath]	4 Year	Full time
9	Smt. Sharda Devi	Community Organizer	Intermediate	5 Year	Full time
10	Mr. Shashikant	Child Right Worker	Intermediate	3 Year	Part Time
11	Mr. Rohit	Community Organizer	BA	2 Year	Part Time
12	Mr. Awanish Kumar	Child Right Worker	Intermediate	2 Year	Part Time
13	Mr. Sudhir Kr. Mishra	Block Programme Coordinator	MSW	2 Year	Full time
14	Mr. Akhilesh Verma	Field Coordinator	MA	2 Year	Full time
15	Mr. Virendra Tiwari	Field Coordinator	BA	3 Year	Full time
16	Mr. Rajkumar	Field Coordinator	BA	4 Year	Full time

Expert Group

S. No.	Name	Age	Sex	Qualification	Experience	Expertise
1	Mr. Manish Sisodia	40	Male	Master in Journalism	20 Years	Right To Information, Media, Film Production on social causes
2	Ms. Krinna Shah	38	Female	MSW	12 Years	Child Rights, Anti-Human Trafficking, JJ Act

3	Mr. Tapas Kumar	32	Male	MSW	10 Years	Community Health, Participatory Trainings, Programme Management, Documentation, , Monitoring and Evaluation
4.	Mr. R. C. Dwivedi	48	Male	MA [Sociology] LLB	20 Years	Legal Issues especially related to Child Rights

Stories of Change

a) The greatest joy is to see our children eat full meal and go to school- Rama Devi

I was very young when I got married into a joint family. Illiterate and vulnerable I depended solely on my in-laws for support. However, despite contributing to family income and household work I was thrown out by my brother in law. He eyed the ancestral property. Fortunately, I met Jitendra ji and Suresh ji from Dehat organization. They encouraged me to apply for ASHA. I applied and was selected. Working on women and child health gave me a new confidence besides of course the income that I so very needed. This also gave me the space to venture out, meet other women and discuss our problems. Soon, we started our own SHG, which was the first one to start in the area. Through SHG support I opened a general store in the village. In no time, I was earning enough to run my family comfortably. There was a sense of achievement and confidence that we can stand against exploitation. One thing led to another, with other women in my village I also attended Tarakshar program run by Dehat, attended Mahila Sadan for Aaroh program representing my district, participated in different anti corruption actions in the area but the greatest joy is to see our children eat full meal and go to school.

b) We wanted our right and not charity - Rajumari Maurya

I saw Rama's SHG working so well that I soon started one of my own with nine other women. Initially none of knew how to read and write. When Khajanchi Bhai from Dehat organization told us about Tarakshar Program we all jumped with joy. Today, I sign my name and so do the other women in the village. Through our SHG we were supported in times of financial constraints. I used the loan from SHG for our fields. Other women in our group used theirs to buy farming equipments, household material, cattle, some like Rama started their own shops. SHG meetings also brought us closer as a group. Besides, the usual

SHG issues we would discuss our personal problems and challenges. During these meetings the problem discussed most was the constant unavailability of ration at our local public ration shop and the rude behaviour of the shopkeeper. We decided that food is our basic right and we are entitled to receive our quota of ration on time. First and foremost, we spoke to the shopkeeper who rebuked us instead of listening to our complain. So, we wrote to the District Magistrate who soon initiated an investigation. This letter was signed by more than seventy two women of our village. Officials would visit us and try to get us agree to some negotiation. The shopkeeper would sometime threaten us and sometime try to bribe us. But, we were undeterred and declared to keep fighting against his corrupt ways. We wanted our right and not charity. Scared by investigation and the likely charges he bowed down to our demands and agreed to work honestly. Today, all of us get our due share of ration and the shopkeeper is polite and courteous.

c) When a broom won us a safe school roof - Sushila Devi

I am a women farmer and the sole bread winner for my family. You can understand the challenges I would be facing every day. And how difficult it would be if you are illiterate, if you are a woman and if you have no idea of your rights or a life outside that of your village? Initially the women remained bound to their family and homes so interaction between them was minimal. However when we started our SHG things started changing. We realized how we have so much in common and how so many challenges we face everyday remains essentially the same. I used the loan from my SHG to buy equipments for farming. After having seen the benefits of SHG and also realizing the limitations of being illiterate we took to Tarakshar program like a mother takes to her child. Being able to sign my name spelled a new confidence in living. The shared joy from the struggle to improve our economic situation or to learning how to read and write brought all of us much much closer. We realized the power of Collective and collective struggle. For instance, in our village a new primary school building was being constructed. One of the villagers saw the roof leaking and informed us. All the women decided to stop the construction work immediately. We went to the site, fought with the contractor and warned him that unless good quality material is used for construction, work will remain suspended. This news spread like fire. Whenever any official would come to check the site all the women will march

with brooms in their hands and surround the site. After four months of struggle we forced the Contractor to re-build the roof with good quality material. Imagine the tragedy that could have struck us if we remained docile and let our children study in a school with a leaking roof. Sometimes only a broom can win a safe roof.

d) My wife secured livelihood for us even after her death- Shivpujan

I am a tailor but not till recently I worked from home since I did not have money to buy or rent a shop of my own. We were a family of four with all the needs of family of growing children. Motivated by other women of the village Sunita, my wife, also joined the Mahalaxmi SHG opened at the intervention of Dehat organisation. I did not quite understand the role of SHG or how it could benefit us then. However, I decided not to object to my wife's involvement. Almost two and a half years of joining this SHG, Sunita passed away. I was shaken by her sudden death. I thought I lost my companion. Little did I know how my wife secured livelihood for us even after her death! As part of SHG she was insured and so I received some ten thousand Rupees on account of her sudden demise. Dehat helped me in dealing with the formalities required to make the claim. With this money I started my own tailoring shop near the main road. Today I have three sewing machines and two workers to help me with the work. Both my children go to school and I don't worry about the family expenses anymore.

e) A life with dignity for us and our children – Bhanmati

I don't know how long I have been living in Nai Basti. It seems all my life. However until recently we hardly had any existence. We were like living beings who sleep walk instead of living. With no rights whatsoever, no home to call our own, no land that belonged to us, no regular work, no regular income we lived constantly under the shadow of Forest officials. Four years ago, it was a meeting with Dehat members which gave us some hope. I remember the first of the few things done was RTI applications on PDS (public distribution schemes). We had no ration card till then. Then started a struggle that led us to where we are today. I resolved not to take liquor and instead became more and more involved in struggle activities. Lot of things happened in those three to four years. We were threatened by officials; our people were arrested and kept in district jail. But, by then cat was out of bag. We were increasingly becoming aware of our rights and

a lot of organizing around six to seven villages also bound us into a close group for common cause. Soon, we launched a Foot march from Nai Basti to District prison opposing the arrest of our people and appealing general public for support. The response was overwhelming. We learnt that not only people in the nearby areas stood in support but also several inside the district prison took a hunger strike in our support. The officials soon gave up and we walked back ecstatic with our people and all our demands met. Today, we have ration card, we have lands in our name and we have a job card under NREGA scheme. But most of all we won a life of dignity for us and our children.

f) By making our village liquor free we secured our children's future-Geeta Prasad

I live in Kailash nagar. It is a village that had for long suffered bonded labour. Most of us were Begaar (bonded labour) and knew no other way to live. Even when the country became independent and bonded labour was abolished our situation remained unchanged. Only now, the white oppressors were replaced by the Brown ones. I can't even recount the several different ways we were exploited by Forest officials. However, we soon organized ourselves into a group and refused Dehsaari (local practice to give part of daily produce to Forest Department). This infuriated the officials but we continued with our protest. We also did whatever we could to facilitate life for instance with our own hands we constructed the road to our village. It was after some years that we met people from Dehat organization. In one of the initial meetings Jitendra Bhai asked us to file RTIs to know the Liquor consumption by our village and the result shocked us. On breaking the statistics we received from government we realized that one man alone spends some 8000Rs on liquor in a year. Of course as you know drinking breeds further evils and domestic violence is prime amongst them. So another 1000Rs would go in treatment and medicines. The entire village resolved to abstain from liquor. Today our village is one of the only Liquor free villages in the district. And we can already see the benefits. I have a Pucca roof on my house now and make substantial savings. Not to mention the peace in the family! By making our village liquor free we secured our children's future, gained respect and equality in the society and contributed significantly in the Vangram movement.

g) I struggled to reserve our rights first and now I run the first railway reservation counter in the region- Saroj Gupta

I dropped out of school when I failed high school in 1998. However after four years, I again started and passed senior school. I was always interested in local events and developments. It was during one such event that I saw Dr. Jung Hindustani from Dehat organization train villagers on filing RTI Applications. This was quite hands on, people filed RTIs and on learning the statistics taking action to further their struggle for rights. I found the struggle quite credible and joined it. You can say I carried on the first of its kind sting operation in our area by capturing on my camera, a watchman while he was cutting the forest trees. I was writing for a local newspaper when some villagers reported a tiger caught in the area. I went to the site with my camera and recorded the subsequent events. The tiger was captured by villagers who informed forest officials. The officers applauded the villagers and took the tiger with them. Later, some of the villagers were arrested on charges of killing that tiger which undoubtedly died in forest official's custody. Hadn't it been for the video recording I did which proved that the tiger was alive when forest officials took it innocent villagers would have been put behind the bars. I realized unless we fight for our rights a life with dignity isn't coming. So, I plunged completely into the movement further mobilizing youth. I was soon arrested along with others during and put into district prison. Thousands of villagers marched on foot to the prison to free us. Several fellow prisoners on hearing the news launched hunger strike inside the prison. This was incredible show of support! Soon, Government officials forced by people's struggle not only freed us but also agreed to all our demands. Back to my village, I took loan and opened this shop which is a one point stop for general merchandise, photocopies, internet and reservation counter. Today I earn enough to support my family. You can say that I struggled to reserve our rights first and now I run the first railway reservation counter in the region.

h) Struggle for freedom changed our view of women- Banshidhar

I am the village chief and have no doubts in saying that Bhanmati is our leader. We would have continued to live like slaves had it not been for the struggle initiated by Dehat and our women folks. We men were initially very apprehensive of the struggle and of what it would ultimately lead us to. However, it took several public meetings and discussions before we understood its full import.

Not to mention, the sacrifices it would demand from us. But, when the choice is between living and dying (in our case living like dead) there are no real options. There was no hope in continuing with our then situation, there was still some hope from getting together and fighting. And this is what the struggle did to us. But, the credit goes to the women who saw beyond the individual interest and also inspired us to struggle for a life with dignity. Struggle for freedom changed our view of women. I still remember, when we set on the footmarch somewhere deep down I knew freedom is close by. I am sure this is what others felt too. And I now know that we were able to win our freedom from exploitative forest practices only because men, women and child walked hand in hand. Jai Adhikar!!
